

Non-verbal Communication

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Non- verbal Communication



It includes **all unwritten and unspoken messages intended or not.**

These **silent signals** have a **strong effect** on receivers.

But **understanding them is not simple.**

Non-verbal Communication

Downward glance
here indicate
modesty or Fatigue?



Non- verbal Communication

Does a constant stare
reflect coldness?

Dullness?

Aggression?



Non- verbal Communication

Do crossed arms mean defensiveness? Withdrawal? Or do crossed arms just mean that a person is shivering?



Functions of Nonverbal Communication

Reinforcement:

Nonverbal communication is used to emphasize some part of the verbal message. Nonverbal behaviours may complement or add to words. You might smile when telling a story (to suggest that you find it humorous). Public speakers often emphasize verbal statements with forceful gestures and increases in volume and inflection.

Modification:

Nonverbal behaviours may contradict verbal messages, as when a group member says, “Nothing’s wrong” in a hostile tone of voice. You might also cross your fingers or wink to indicate that you are lying.



Point as you say “The office is the second door on the left.”



Functions of Nonverbal Communication

Substitution:

You may also use nonverbal communication to substitute or take the place of verbal messages. For instance, you can signal “okay” with a hand gesture. You can nod your head to indicate yes or shake your head to indicate no.



Regulation:

Movements may be used to regulate or control the flow of verbal messages. We use our eyes and body posture to indicate that we want to enter conversations, and speakers' step back from a podium to indicate that they have finished a speech. We invite people to speak by looking directly at them, often after asking a question.



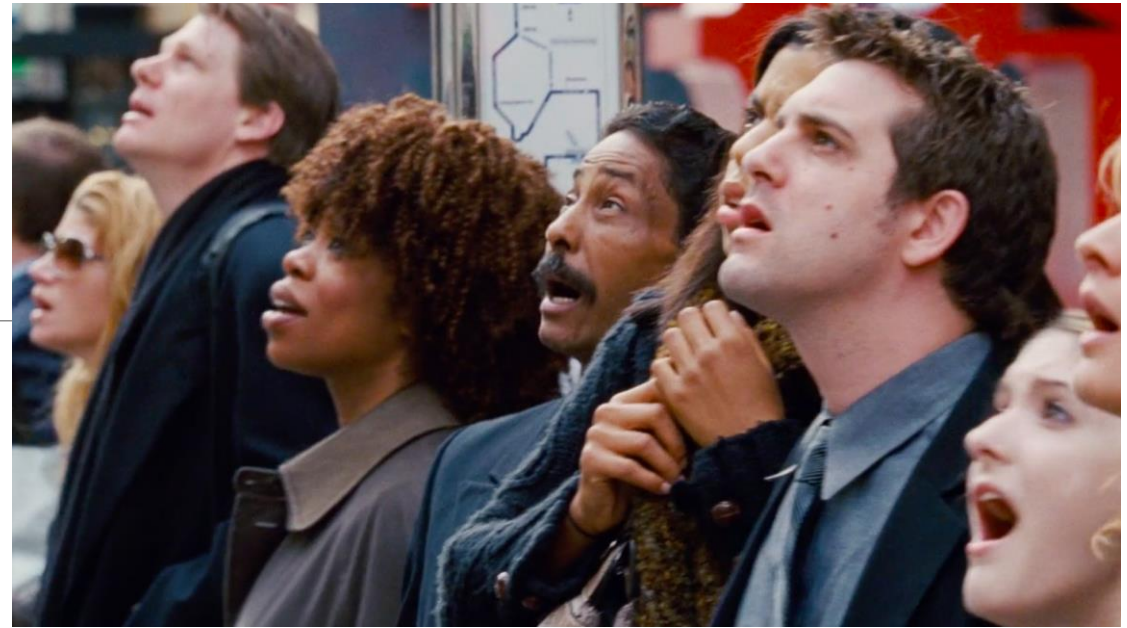
Classification of Nonverbal Communication

- i. Environnemental Codes
- ii. Person Oriented Codes
- iii. Temporal Codes



Environmental Codes

Environmental factors are **elements of setting that affect how we feel and act.**



For instance, we respond to architecture, colours, room design, temperature, sounds, smell, and lighting. Colour also influences perceptions and behaviours. We feel solemn in mosques with their somber colours.

People's acceptance of a product, for example, is largely determined by its packaging, especially colour.

Environmental Codes

Rooms with comfortable chairs invite relaxation, whereas rooms with stiff chairs prompt formality. Restaurants use environmental features to control how long people linger over meals.

For example, low lights, comfortable chairs or booths, and soft music often are part of the environment in upscale restaurants. On the other hand, fast food eateries have hard plastic booths and bright lights, which encourage diners to eat and move on.

Person Oriented Codes



i. Physical Appearance:

People make inferences about who you are – in part – **by the way you dress.**

Whether these inferences are accurate or not, they will influence what people think of you and how they react to you.

Your body also reveals your race through skin colour and tone and may also give clues as to your more specific nationality.

Your weight in proportion to your height will also communicate messages to others as will the length, colour, and style of your hair.

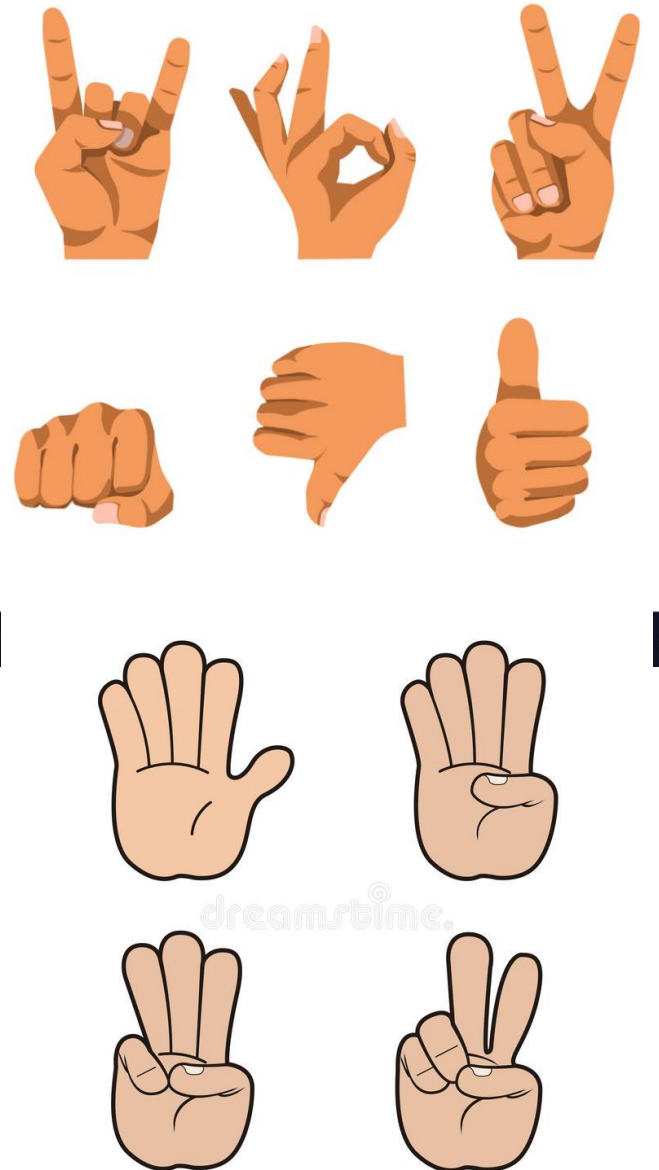
Person Oriented Codes

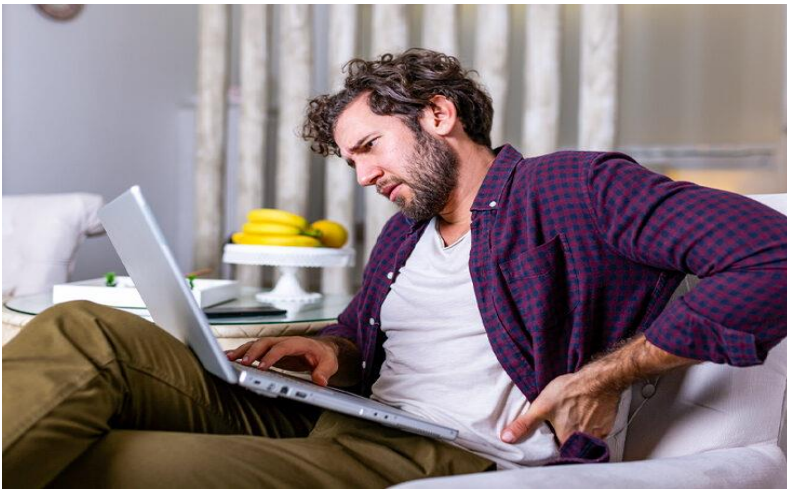
ii. Gestures and Body Movements

There are five major types of body movements.

a) Emblems are body gestures that directly translate into words or phrases, for example, the okay sign, the thumbs up for “good job,” and the “V” for victory. Emblems are culture specific, so be careful when using your culture’s emblems in other cultures.

b) Illustrators enhance the verbal messages they accompany. For example, when referring to something to the left, you might gesture toward the left. You might also use illustrators to communicate the shape or size of objects you are talking about.





Person Oriented Codes

c) Affect displays are movements of the face (smiling or frowning, for example) but also of the hands and general body (body tenseness or relaxing posture, for example) that communicate emotional meaning.



d) Regulators are behaviours that monitor, control, coordinate, or maintain the speaking of another individual. When you nod your head, for example, you tell the speaker to keep on speaking; when you lean forward and open your mouth, you tell the speaker that you would like to say something.



e) Adaptors are gestures that satisfy some personal need, for example, moving your hair out of your eyes. *Self-adaptors* are self touching movements (for example, rubbing your nose). *Alter-adaptors* are movements directed at the person with whom you are speaking (for example, removing a stray thread from someone's jacket). *Object-adaptors* are those gestures focused on objects, for example, doodling on or shredding a paper.

Person Oriented Codes

iii. Facial Communication:

Throughout the communication, **your face communicates various messages, especially your emotions.** Some nonverbal researchers claim that facial movements may express at least the following eight emotions: happiness, surprise, fear, anger, sadness, disgust, contempt, and interest. There are four facial management techniques:

a. Intensifying helps you exaggerate a feeling, for example, exaggerating surprise when friends throw you a party to make your friends feel better.

b. De-intensifying helps you underplay a feeling, for example, to cover up your own joy in the presence of a friend who didn't receive such good news.



Person Oriented Codes



c. **Neutralizing** helps you hide feelings, for example, to cover up your sadness to not to depress others.

d. **Masking** helps you to replace or substitute the expression of one emotion for another, for example, to express happiness in order to cover up your disappointment in not receiving the gift you had expected.

Person Oriented Codes

v. Personal Space and Touching Behaviour:

Proxemics is space and how we use it. Every culture has norms for using space and for how close people should be to one another.

<i>Relationship</i>	<i>Distance</i>	
Intimate relationship	0	18 inches
Personal relationship	1.5	4 feet
Social relationship	4	12 feet
Public relationship	12	25+ feet

Person Oriented Codes

vi. Vocal Characteristics:

Paralanguage refers to the vocal (but nonverbal) dimension of speech. It refers to **how you say something, not what you say**. It includes sounds, such as murmurs, and vocal qualities, such as pitch, rhythm, volume and inflection. Vocal cues signal others to interpret what we say as a joke, threat, statement of fact, or question. When you speak quickly, for example, you communicate something different than when you speak slowly. Even though the words might be the same, if the speed (or volume, rhythm, or pitch) differs, the meaning people receive will also differ.

Temporal Codes

Temporal communication (chronemics) concerns the use of time – how you organize it, how you react to it, and the messages it communicates. There are two aspects of temporal communication: Cultural time, and Psychological time.

Time can be viewed as: *technical or scientific time* (milliseconds, light years), *formal time* (seconds, minutes, weeks, seasons), *informal time* (forever, as soon as possible, never, immediately).

Temporal Codes

People may have *displaced time orientation* (being exactly on time), or *diffused time orientation* (seeing time as approximate rather than exact).

Monochronic people or cultures schedule one thing at a time, whereas *polychronic* people or cultures schedule a number of things at the same time.

Your culture and your more specific society maintains a time schedule (social clock) for the right time to do a variety of important things (for example, the right time to start school, go out with friends, get married, get a job).

Silence

Like words and gestures, silence also communicates important meanings and serves important functions. Silence allows the speaker time to think, time to formulate, and organize his or her verbal communication. Silence can also communicate awkwardness. People may use silence to hurt others, prevent communication of certain messages, communicate emotional responses, or when they have nothing to say.

Environmental Codes

Colour

Volume/space

Objects in the environment

Light Intensity

Personal Space